

# Acme Corporation Employee Handbook

HR Policy Manual — Edition 2023

## Section 1. Introduction

This handbook describes the employment policies of Acme Corporation for the 2023 calendar year. It supersedes the 2022 edition in full. Acme operates in 16 countries and employs approximately 3,450 people. This edition introduces expanded parental leave, a hybrid work model, and a new wellness stipend.

## Section 2. Working Hours and Remote Work

### 2.1 Standard Hours

Standard working hours remain 40 hours per week. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 local time. Teams may establish additional team-specific hours with director approval.

### 2.2 Hybrid Work Model

Beginning July 2023, Acme adopts a hybrid work model. Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. Tuesday and Thursday are designated as in-office anchor days for all teams in locations with an Acme office. Fully remote arrangements require VP approval and are reviewed semi-annually.

The home office stipend increases to \$600 for new remote workers. A monthly internet allowance of \$40 is introduced for employees on hybrid or fully remote schedules.

## Section 3. Compensation

### 3.1 Salary Reviews

Merit increase pool for 2023 was set at 4.0 percent. Salary reviews continue to occur in March with adjustments effective April 1. Promotions may result in adjustments of 10 to 18 percent.

### 3.2 Bonus Plan

The annual performance bonus target is 10 percent for individual contributors, 15 percent for managers, and 25 percent for directors. A new spot bonus program allows managers to award up to \$5,000 to employees for exceptional contributions, subject to VP approval.

### 3.3 Wellness Stipend

Effective January 2023, all full-time employees receive a \$75 monthly wellness stipend covering gym memberships, fitness equipment, mental health services, and wellness apps. The stipend is administered via the Acme Benefits Portal and unused amounts do not carry over.

## **Section 4. Leave Policies**

### **4.1 Paid Time Off**

Full-time employees accrue 22 days of PTO per year, plus 11 company holidays. Accrual is 1.83 days per month. Carryover increases to 8 days. PTO requests must be submitted at least 5 business days in advance through Workday.

### **4.2 Sick Leave**

Paid sick leave increases to 10 days per year. Sick leave may be used for personal illness, medical appointments, or care of an immediate family member. Sick leave does not carry over.

### **4.3 Parental Leave**

Effective January 2023, parental leave increases to 16 weeks of fully paid leave for primary caregivers and 10 weeks for secondary caregivers. Leave may be split into up to two blocks within 15 months of the child's birth, adoption, or placement. Employees must notify HR at least 60 days in advance.

### **4.4 Bereavement Leave**

Bereavement leave is expanded to 7 days for immediate family and 3 days for extended family. Additional unpaid leave may be arranged.

### **4.5 Caregiver Leave**

A new caregiver leave policy provides up to 4 weeks of paid leave per year for employees caring for a seriously ill immediate family member. Certification from a physician is required.

## **Section 5. Code of Conduct**

### **5.1 Standards**

All employees must complete compliance training by May 31 each year. A new data privacy module is added covering GDPR and CCPA obligations relevant to every role.

### **5.2 Reporting Violations**

The Ethics Hotline remains available at [ethics@acmecorp.example](mailto:ethics@acmecorp.example). A new anonymous web portal is launched at [ethics.acmecorp.example](https://ethics.acmecorp.example).